

Etsy– Online Marketplace for Handmade, Vintage, and Craft Supplies

1.INTRODUCTION

Etsy is a global e-commerce platform that connects independent sellers with buyers looking for handmade products, vintage items (20+ years old), and craft supplies. Unlike traditional online shopping websites, Etsy focuses on unique, customized, and creative products made by artisans, designers, and small business owners.

The platform enables sellers to create their own online stores, list products, manage orders, receive payments, and communicate directly with customers. Buyers can browse millions of products, save favorites , purchase securely, and leave reviews.

1.1 Project Overview

Project Name: Etsy Marketplace System

Project Type: Business-to-Consumer (B2C) E-Commerce Platform

Industry: Online Retail

Users:

- Buyers
- Sellers
- Administrators

Platform:

- Website
- Mobile Application

1.2 Problem Statement

Small businesses, artisans, and craft makers often struggle to sell their products because traditional marketplaces are expensive, highly competitive, and mainly focus on mass-produced items. Customers looking for handmade, personalized, or vintage products also find it difficult to discover authentic sellers.

The project aims to provide an online marketplace where independent sellers can easily showcase and sell unique products while offering buyers a secure and user-friendly shopping experience

1.3 Business Objectives

The primary business objectives are:

- Increase online sales of handmade products.
- Support independent sellers.
- Expand the customer base globally.
- Provide secure payment methods.
- Improve customer satisfaction.
- Generate revenue through listing fees, transaction fees, and advertising.
- Maintain trust through product reviews and seller ratings.

1.4 Key Objectives

- Provide a reliable online marketplace.
- Allow sellers to manage their own stores.
- Enable buyers to search and purchase products easily.
- Ensure secure online transactions.
- Offer order tracking.
- Improve communication between buyers and sellers.
- Build customer loyalty through reviews and recommendations.

1.5 Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role
Buyers	Purchase products and provide reviews
Sellers	List products, manage inventory, fulfill orders
Administrator	Manages users, products, disputes, and platform operations
Payment Gateway	Processes secure payments
Delivery Partners	Deliver products to customers

Stakeholder	Role
Customer Support Team	Resolves customer issues
Marketing Team	Promotes products and campaigns
Investors	Provide financial support and monitor business growth

1.6 System Requirements

Functional Requirements

User Management

- User registration
- Login and logout
- Password recovery
- Profile management

Seller Module

- Create seller account
- Add/Edit/Delete products
- Upload product images
- Manage inventory
- View orders
- Update shipping status
- View earnings

Buyer Module

- Search products
- Filter products
- Add to cart
- Wishlist
- Secure checkout

- Online payment
- Order history
- Product reviews

Admin Module

- Manage users
- Manage sellers
- Approve product listings
- Remove inappropriate products
- View reports
- Resolve disputes
- Monitor transactions

Payment Module

- Online payment
- Payment confirmation
- Refund management

Shipping Module

- Order tracking
- Shipping updates
- Delivery confirmation

1.7 Business Requirements

The business requires the platform to:

- Allow sellers to create online stores.
- Provide buyers with a secure shopping experience.
- Enable digital payments.
- Support product reviews and ratings.
- Offer personalized product recommendations.
- Generate sales reports.
- Support multiple currencies and languages.

- Provide customer support.
- Reduce fraudulent transactions.

1.8 Conclusion

Etsy is a successful e-commerce marketplace that empowers independent creators, artisans, and small businesses to reach customers worldwide. By providing secure payments, seller management tools, product discovery, reviews, and reliable order processing, the platform creates value for both buyers and sellers. Its focus on handmade, vintage, and craft products distinguishes it from traditional e-commerce platforms and supports a vibrant global community of creative entrepreneurs.









